

Backing Up Your Data with UrBackup



Data is extremely important because, without it, an organisation will not be able to meet its purpose. Backing up data is even more important, just in case of any disaster — manmade or natural. This article discusses an open source network backup solution, called UrBackup.

Data can be stolen from digital ecosystems by hackers. This data loss can compromise your personal identity, and even bankrupt your company. No matter what you store — years of highly sensitive and confidential data or just pictures of your dogs — you never want to find out that most or all of it has been compromised. This is where data backup comes in to save the day.

Why is backup needed?

The main reason for a backup is to possess a secure archive of important information, whether that's classified documents for your business or treasured photos of your family, so that you can restore it to your device quickly and seamlessly in the event of loss of data.

What data should I back up?

In general, you should back up data that can't be replaced easily. Some examples are word documents, spreadsheets, databases (for financial data), customer data, and personal files such as pictures, music files, emails, etc.

As a thumb rule, system folders don't need a backup. Programs will need to be reinstalled before you can run them and system folders will be restored from your OS installation disk. Be sure to save program installation disks, operating system disks and registration information in a safe place. If you have downloaded any applications, you should always save their installation files.

Most backup solutions are very costly and that's a good reason to select UrBackup. In this server-client solution, you install the server on your Windows machine, which allows you to back up any Windows, macOS, or Linux machine (using the UrBackup client software) to the desired server.

UrBackup is a simple and easy-to-setup client/server backup system. This is done through a mix of image and file

backups, achieving both data safety and quick restoration. File and image backups are created while the system is running without interfering with current processes. UrBackup also constantly observes the folders that you would like to back up in order to quickly find differences from previous backups. Because of that, incremental file backups are really fast. It has a Web interface that shows the status of the clients, current activities, logs and statistics. It allows the administrator to manage backup settings and override the settings for the clients. Previously stored file backups can be browsed, and files from these backups can be extracted or restored.

Drawbacks of UrBackup

Image backups only work with volumes that are NTFS formatted and with the Windows client. The drives must be MBR or GPT partitioned, and the partition should be a primary one. Dynamic volumes are not supported. Mirrored dynamic volumes work, but aren't officially supported. Backup to VHD files only works for volumes with a size lesser than 2TB.

UrBackup alternatives and competitors are:

1. Bareos (Backup Archiving REcovery Open Sourced)
2. Duplicati

Installation of UrBackup server

1. Download UrBackup server from the link <https://hndl.urbbackup.org/Server/2.4.13/UrBackup%20Server%202.4.13.exe>.
2. Install UrBackup server by accepting the terms and conditions.
3. Now that you have successfully installed it, go to the Web interface (<http://localhost:55414>), and then to the settings, and configure the folder where UrBackup should store the backups of the clients (see Figure 1).
4. After configuring the folder, if you get an error '*on-access virus scanner active in temporary file path*', just exclude Windows security to scan in the path. This can be done by *Search -> Windows security -> Virus and threat protection -> Virus and threat protection settings -> Manage settings -> Add or remove exclusions -> Add exclusion* (the path for the backup folder). See Figure 2.